

Your First Prompt

You talk to Claude Code like you would any AI assistant. Here are a few things to consider that can both protect you and make things easier.

[Auto-accept vs. approval](#) · [Plan Mode](#) · [A worked example](#) · [Recap](#)

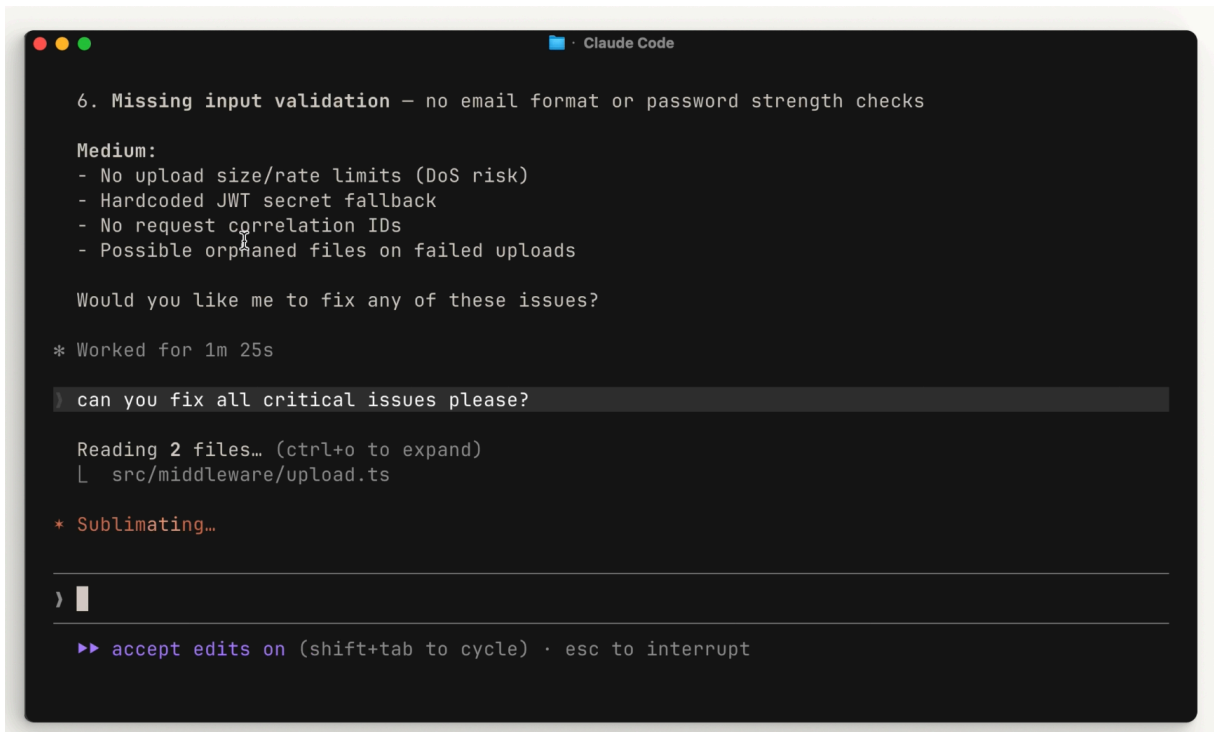
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01 Auto-Accept vs. Approval

You can choose whether Claude auto-accepts every file change it suggests, or whether it asks for your explicit permission each time. Press `Shift + Tab` to cycle between modes.

Mode	What happens
Approval mode	Claude asks permission each time it wants to edit a file or run a command.
Auto-accept mode	File edits are approved automatically, but commands still require your permission.



```
6. Missing input validation – no email format or password strength checks

Medium:
- No upload size/rate limits (DoS risk)
- Hardcoded JWT secret fallback
- No request correlation IDs
- Possible orphaned files on failed uploads

Would you like me to fix any of these issues?

* Worked for 1m 25s

> can you fix all critical issues please?

Reading 2 files... (ctrl+o to expand)
└─ src/middleware/upload.ts

* Sublimating...

> █

▶▶ accept edits on (shift+tab to cycle) · esc to interrupt
```

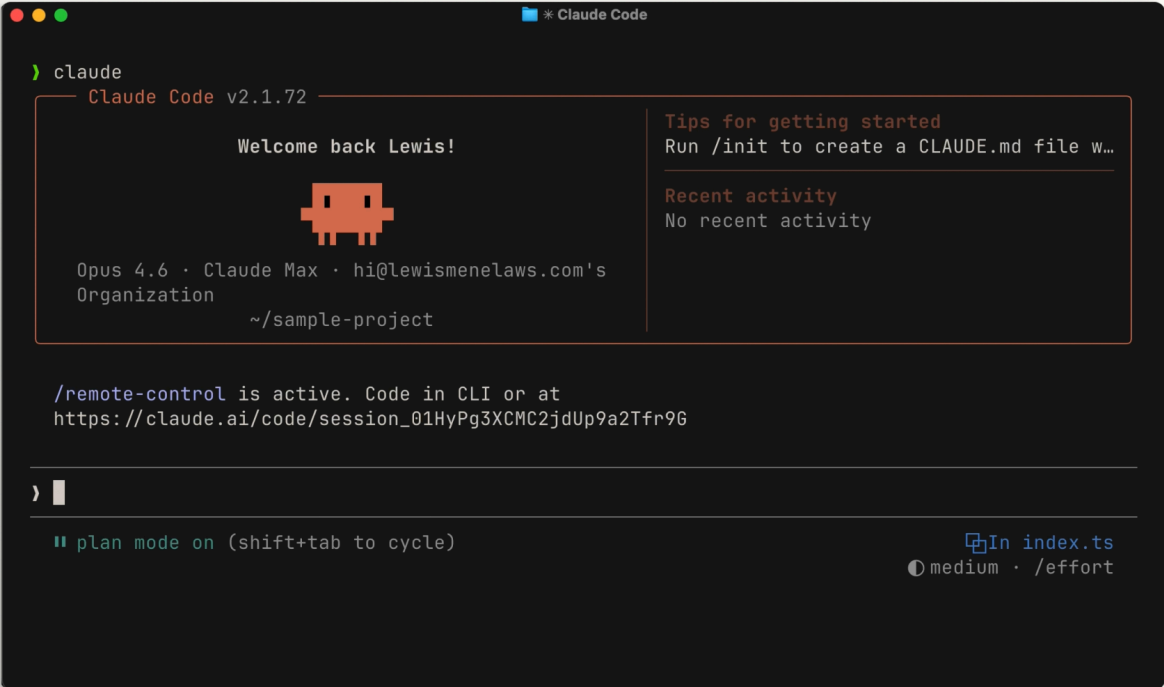
In auto-accept mode, the footer reads “accept edits on” - file edits apply automatically.

NO WRONG ANSWER

There’s no right or wrong choice here - use whichever mode you’re most comfortable with.

02 Plan Mode

Within the `Shift + Tab` menu is Plan Mode. Plan Mode takes your prompt and uses read-only tools to analyze your codebase and research your suggested implementation. It asks clarifying questions along the way, then returns a detailed plan it can execute.



```
) claude
  Claude Code v2.1.72

  Welcome back Lewis!

  [Robot Icon]

  Opus 4.6 · Claude Max · hi@lewismenelaws.com's
  Organization
  ~ /sample-project

  /remote-control is active. Code in CLI or at
  https://claude.ai/code/session_01HyPg3XCMC2jdUp9a2Tfr9G

  plan mode on (shift+tab to cycle)

  In index.ts
  medium · /effort
```

When Plan Mode is active, the footer reads “plan mode on.”

WHEN TO REACH FOR PLAN MODE

Plan Mode shines for complex, multi-step changes - or for a safe, read-only code review before any code is touched.

03 Example: Add a Dark Mode Toggle

Let's walk through an example. Say you have an application that needs a dark mode toggle. Open the root directory of your project and run `claude`, then press `Shift + Tab` a couple of times to enter Plan Mode and write a prompt like:

You can clone the demo project from the link below and run it locally: [Demo Files](#)

TRY A PROMPT LIKE THIS

› My app needs a dark mode implemented across the entire app. Can you create a toggle switch on the header that allows a user to toggle between light mode and dark mode? I need you to find a good contrast color that works based on my existing light theme.

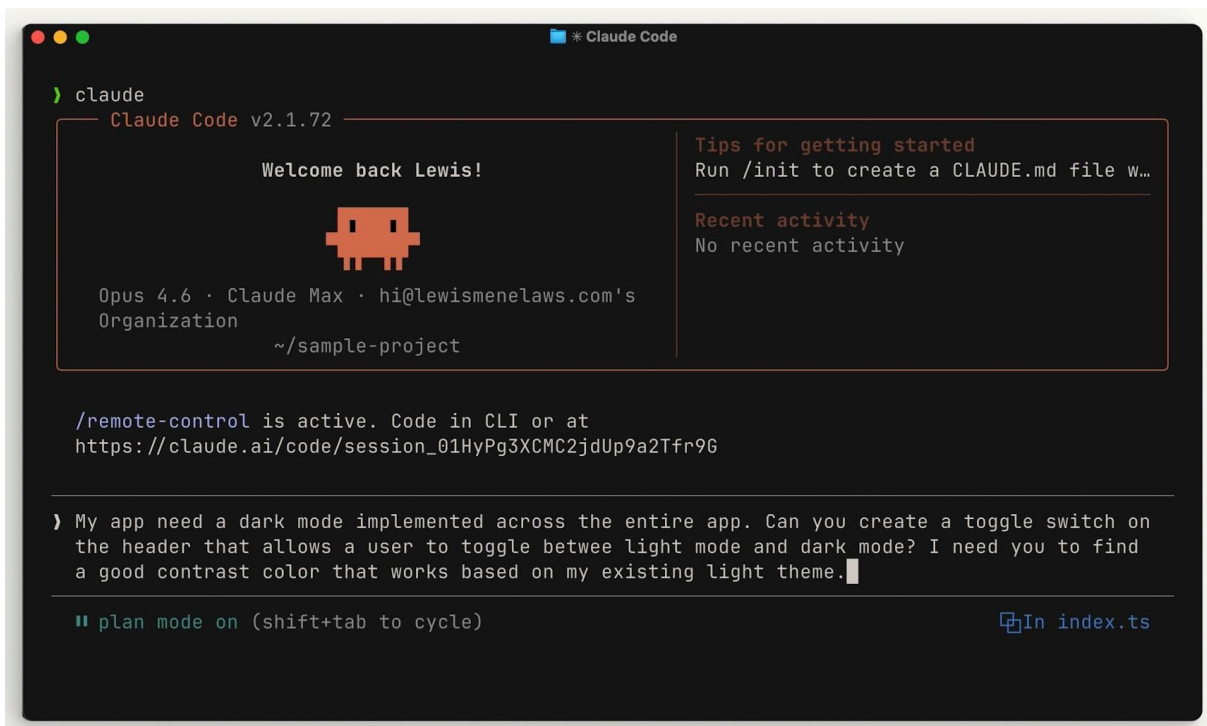
OR

My app needs a dark mode implemented across the entire application.

Requirements:

- Add a dark mode toggle switch in the header.
- The toggle should persist the user's preference using localStorage.
- Use CSS variables instead of duplicating styles.
- Find accessible contrast colors that work well with the existing light theme.
- Ensure all sections (hero, features, testimonials, pricing, footer, buttons, cards, navigation, and links) support dark mode.
- Add smooth transitions between themes.
- Update the README with a brief explanation of how the dark mode implementation works.

Before making changes, analyze the existing styling approach and provide a short implementation plan.



```
> claude
Claude Code v2.1.72

Welcome back Lewis!

Opus 4.6 · Claude Max · hi@lewismenelaws.com's
Organization
~/sample-project

Tips for getting started
Run /init to create a CLAUDE.md file w...

Recent activity
No recent activity

/remote-control is active. Code in CLI or at
https://claude.ai/code/session_01HyPg3XCMC2jdUp9a2Tfr9G

) My app need a dark mode implemented across the entire app. Can you create a toggle switch on
the header that allows a user to toggle betwee light mode and dark mode? I need you to find
a good contrast color that works based on my existing light theme.

" plan mode on (shift+tab to cycle) In index.ts
```

Entering the prompt in Plan Mode - the footer confirms "plan mode on."

Let Claude plan it out. After reviewing the plan, if it looks good, accept it and let Claude ask you for approval at each step. At the end, you can see exactly what Claude did and how it reached its conclusions.

04 Recap

When using Claude Code, try to be as descriptive as possible with your prompt. A little extra context up front gives Claude a much better shot at the result you want.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Be as descriptive as possible with your prompt.
- Want to stay in the loop at every step? You can - approval mode keeps you in control.
- Use Plan Mode to let Claude dig into the details of what you want before executing any code.

Be descriptive, stay in control, and let Plan Mode do the thinking first.